

March 24, 2026

Hiring Committee
Center for American Progress

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Chief Economist position at the Center for American Progress. I am currently a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, where my research focuses on macroeconomics, household finance, and inequality using quantitative models and large-scale micro data. I am particularly drawn to this role because of its emphasis on combining rigorous economic analysis with clear policy leadership to shape an agenda that promotes broad-based economic opportunity.

My research agenda is centered on understanding how economic policies and market structures shape household outcomes and aggregate economic dynamics. In my job market paper, I develop a heterogeneous-agent life-cycle model to study wealth accumulation and inequality, incorporating heterogeneity in returns and income risk to generate policy-relevant insights about distributional outcomes. In complementary work, I analyze micro and panel data from the Health and Retirement Study to examine how trust and financial performance interact over time, applying econometric techniques suited for panel data and causal identification. These projects reflect my broader interest in linking micro-level behavior to macroeconomic outcomes and policy design.

Beyond technical analysis, a central focus of my work is translating complex research into clear, policy-relevant insights. I have experience producing written analysis, visualizations, and presentations that communicate economic findings to diverse audiences. My teaching experience in data-driven and quantitative finance has further strengthened my ability to explain economic concepts in accessible terms, an ability that is essential for engaging with policymakers, media, and the broader public.

I am particularly motivated by American Progress' mission to advance an economy that works for all, including its focus on affordability, labor markets, and economic mobility. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to shaping the organization's research agenda, producing timely and rigorous analysis, and collaborating across teams to support evidence-based policy development. I am especially interested in contributing to work that connects macroeconomic conditions to household-level outcomes and informs policies that promote inclusive and sustainable growth.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would be honored to contribute to American Progress' efforts to advance economic policy that improves the lives of all Americans.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards